Syllabus Edition
First teaching 2025
First exams 2027

Not your syllabus?

Answering 8-Mark Questions

Exam code: 0450, 0986 & 0264, 0774

Download PDF

Written by: Lisa Eades
Reviewed by: Steve Vorster
Updated on 5 September 2025

How do I answer a CIE IGCSE Business 8-mark explain question?

- 'Explain' questions can be asked in **one of three different ways**
- Each type of question requires a slightly different response from you in order to score full marks

Example 1

- **Question samples**
  - **Explain two** ways Gino could increase the number of customers
  - **Explain one advantage and one disadvantage** of TT using environmentally friendly packaging for its products

Guidance

- When asked to explain two points, or an advantage and disadvantage:
  - You receive 1 mark for each valid knowledge [K] point (max. 2)
  - You receive up to three marks for the analytical development [An] of each point
    - One of your points **must be applied** to the context of the question to receive application [Ap]
- The response below would achieve 8 marks as it
  - Clearly sets out **two ways to increase customers**, with specific **references to the business**
  - Develops **strong chains of reasoning**, including relations and how/why points are linked

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

important, and Gino has regular meetings with his part-time employees to keep them informed about any changes to the menu. It took 3 years before Gino's business was able to break-even. He aims to achieve a Return on Capital Employed (ROCE) of 10%. Gino is always looking for ways to increase the number of customers. Inflation may be a problem for Gino's business.

Explain two ways Gino could increase the number of customers.

Knowledge Application Analysis

To increase the number of customers, Gino could advertise his menu or restaurant opening times on social media platforms. This will raise awareness of the business and attract customers to his restaurant. This would be likely to increase revenue and hopefully boost profit, helping him to increase RoCE to 10%, his objective

Gino could use promotional pricing such as "two dishes for the price of one" at certain times of the day. This will help to compensate for the effect of inflation as people will find the discounted food more affordable. The volume of sales would, therefore, likely increase

Example 2

- **Question samples**
  - **Explain** four ways Yasin can advertise MB's products
  - **Explain** two advantages and two disadvantages of TT being a private limited company.

Guidance

- These require you to make **four valid points** that are **supported by information from the case study**
  - Each valid point is awarded a knowledge [K] marks , up to maximum of four marks
  - When a point includes a reference to the case study, a further mark is awarded for application [Ap], up to maximum of four marks
- The response below would achieve 8 marks as it
  - Clearly sets out **four ways to advertise**, each with specific **references to the business**

MB is a small bakery that produces bread. Yasin started the bakery 6 months ago with help from the government. Market research was carried out by Yasin. He asked a small sample of family and friends to fill in a questionnaire.

MB's bread is freshly-made every day in the bakery, which is located at the back of MB's small town centre shop. The

the cheapest ingredients, most of which are imported, and uses packaging that cannot be recycled.

MB's main competitors advertise that they only use ingredients from local suppliers. Yasin is thinking of changing the suppliers he uses for ingredients and packaging. He wants MB to have a good ethical image which he could use in advertising.

Explain four ways Yasin can advertise MB's products.

Knowledge Application

Yasin can use a local newspaper to advertise MB's products, as a discount voucher could be included for money off bread

Yasin could advertise online through his own website and give information about the bread products and ingredients

Leaflets or fliers could be handed out in the town centre so that potential customers will know the shop is nearby

Yasin could use billboards which are found in busy areas of the local town, directing them to the bakery's town centre location

How do I answer a CIE IGCSE Business 8-mark justify question?

- 8-mark justify questions require you to **weigh up contrasting points** and **make a decision using evidence**
- Your marks are awarded as follows:
  - 2 marks for knowledge [K}
  - 2 marks for application [Ap]
  - 2 marks for analysis [An]
  - 2 marks for evaluation [Ev]

Example

- **Question samples**
  - Do you think the advantages for TGD of introducing new technology are greater than the disadvantages? **Justify** your answer.
  - Do you think the benefits to Country Y of having PSN PLC located there are greater than the drawbacks? **Justify** your answer.

- The response below would achieve 8 marks as it
  - Clearly weighs up both the **advantages and disadvantages in context**
  - Develops **strong chains of reasoning**, including relations and how/why points are linked

Do you think the benefits to Country Y of having PSN PLC located there are greater than the drawbacks? Justify your answer.

Teacher only

New! Exclusive Teacher-Only Questions

- Fresh, expert-written questions
- Students can't access them
- Fair accurate tests - built fast

Explore in Test Builder

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Resources

Learning Hub
Scholarship
Join
Past Papers
Solution Banks
Sitemap

Dashboard

Overview
Brand ambassador
Profile
Subscription
Settings
Log out

Company

About us
Exam Specificity
Content Quality
Promotions
Jobs
Terms
Privacy
Cookie Policy
Help and Support

Subjects

Biology
Chemistry
Physics
Maths
Geography
English Literature
Psychology
All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.
Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.